

Japan Equity Strategy

Japan Databook: Greater likelihood of Fed rate hike, expect markets to gain in 4Q

Investment Strategy

Factors: Value up, beta/momentum down

The previous month's pattern held. Value factors such as BPR, forecast EPR and dividend yield improved. Following 1Q results, forecast sales growth for the current fiscal year and earnings estimate revisions also strengthened. Although less than in the previous month, beta and one-year returns deteriorated (Exhibit 1, Exhibit 2).

Return ranking: Broad gains across non-AI stocks

Non-AI sectors that had lagged during the AI rally, including nonferrous metals, shipping, gaming, SaaS companies, retail, food, pharmaceuticals and healthcare, advanced. AI-related stocks rebounded, such as electric wire and cable companies that had entered a correction early. In addition to machinery, AI-related stocks in electronic components, SPE and materials, as well as construction, autos and retail stocks with weaker 1Q results declined (Exhibit 5, Exhibit 6).

Revision ranking: Broad improvement among stocks with strong results

Revisions improved mainly among stocks that reported strong 1Q results, including electric wire and cable companies, SPE, electronic components, retailers such as mass merchandisers, SaaS companies, beverage makers and autos. Paper and pulp, cement, electric utilities, petroleum and coal products and autos deteriorated, extending the pattern seen into the previous month (Exhibit 7, Exhibit 8).

Higher probability of a Fed rate hike in September, but we expect market gains in Oct-Dec

The Jackson Hole symposium was likely a game changer. Chairman Warsh stated that (1) despite recent moderation in inflation indicators, he does not believe underlying inflation has improved meaningfully; (2) current financial conditions cannot be described as restrictive, the most hawkish aspect of his speech; and (3) "we have work to do" as long as there is no confidence that underlying inflation will return to target. Unless August employment or inflation data disappoint considerably, a September rate hike is likely to be approved (28 August, [US Watch](#)). Although markets tend to be volatile before the Fed's first rate hike, negative factors have strongly tended to be largely discounted after the hike provided regions outside the US are not deteriorating (17 August, [Japan Equity Strategy](#) report). A September rate hike by the BoJ is also largely priced in (Exhibit 34, Exhibit 35). The TOPIX revision index has improved to a record high, indicating an excellent earnings streak (Exhibit 19). We believe the peak of the rising-rate and risk-off phase will occur in Jul-Sep and expect market gains in Oct-Dec.

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Investment Strategy
Japan

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SaaS: Software as a Service

SPE: Semiconductor Production
Equipment

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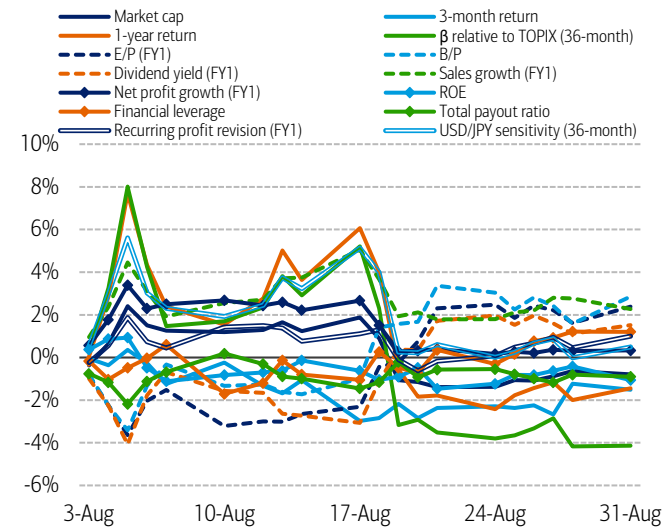
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Refer to important disclosures on page 16 to 18.

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Exhibit 1: Main factor returns (August)

Most effective factors were B/P, E/P (FY1), and Sales growth (FY1)



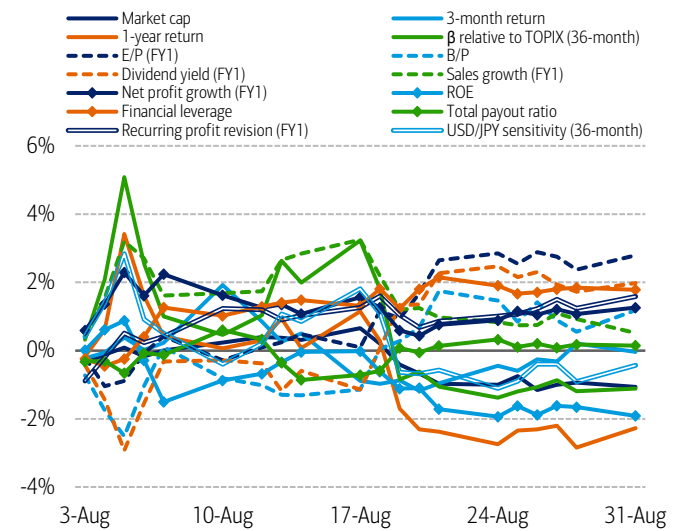
Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

Note: based on TOPIX500

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Exhibit 2: Main factor returns (August, sector-neutralized)

Most effective factors were E/P (FY1), Dividend yield (FY1), and Financial leverage



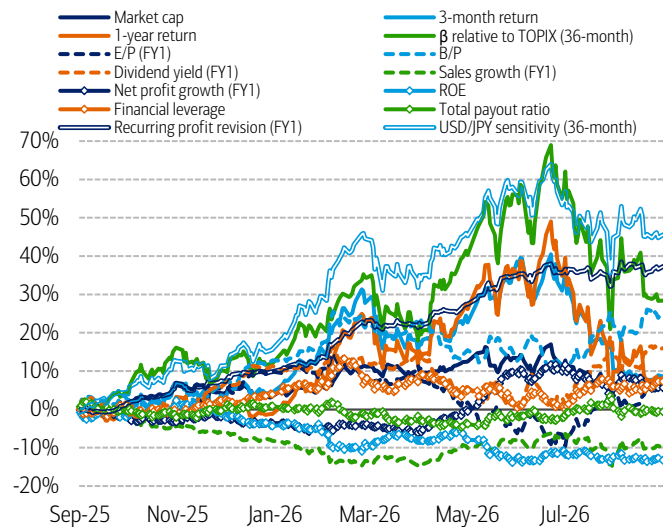
Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

Note: based on TOPIX500

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Exhibit 3: Main factor returns (one-year)

Most effective factors were USD/JPY sensitivity, RP revision (FY1), and β



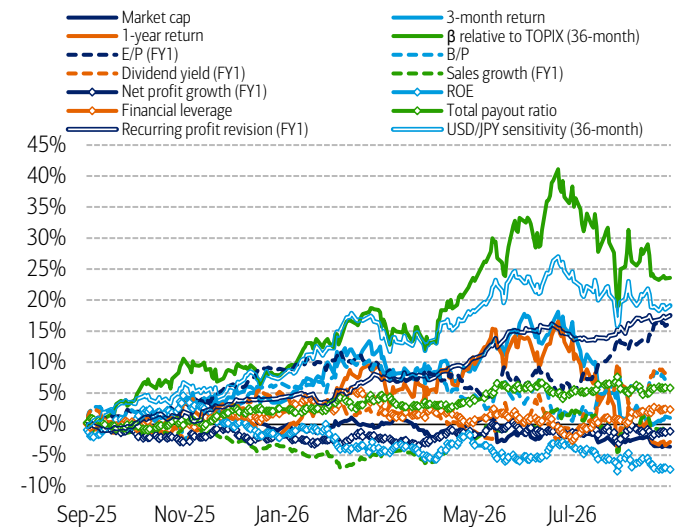
Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

Note: based on TOPIX500

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Exhibit 4: Main factor returns (one-year, sector-neutralized)

Most effective factors were β, USD/JPY sensitivity, and RP revision (FY1)



Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

Note: based on TOPIX500

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Exhibit 5: TOPIX500: Top 50 stocks for returns in August

Stocks with the largest share-price gains in August

Code	Name	Sector	Market cap (bnJPY)	Return (%)
6098	RECRUIT HOLDINGS	Services	26,822	45.1
6952	CASIO COMPUTER	Elec. App.	575	42.4
7272	YAMAHA MOTOR	Trans.Equip.	1,945	42.2
5713	SUMITOMO METAL MINING	Nonfer.Mtls	3,232	35.8
5711	mitsubishi materials	Nonfer.Mtls	744	35.0
5803	FUJIKURA	Nonfer.Mtls	9,771	31.9
4527	ROHTO PHARMACEUTICAL	Pharm.	722	27.9
5801	FURUKAWA ELECTRIC	Nonfer.Mtls	2,841	27.8
3659	NEXON	Inf.&Com.	2,474	26.7
4506	SUMITOMO PHARMA	Pharm.	698	24.5
4689	LY	Inf.&Com.	3,829	24.4
7832	BANDAI NAMCO HOLDINGS	Other Prod.	3,689	24.1
4114	NIPPON SHOKUBAI	Chemicals	401	23.9
4062	IBIDEN	Elec. App.	5,800	22.9
6869	SYSMEX	Elec. App.	1,236	22.8
6645	OMRON	Elec. App.	1,374	22.7
6448	BROTHER INDUSTRIES	Elec. App.	1,229	22.3
5714	DOWA HOLDINGS	Nonfer.Mtls	620	21.4
9843	NITORI HOLDINGS	Retail Trade	1,744	20.1
9104	MITSUI O.S.K. LINES	Marine Trans	2,543	18.9
2269	MEIJI HOLDINGS	Foods	1,267	18.5
6525	KOKUSAI ELECTRIC	Elec. App.	2,087	18.4
3994	MONEY FORWARD	Inf.&Com.	359	18.3
7550	ZENSHO HOLDINGS	Retail Trade	2,013	18.2
4401	ADEKA	Chemicals	461	18.1
4911	SHISEIDO	Chemicals	1,490	18.1
9507	SHIKOKU ELECTRIC POWER	Elec.Pwr&Gas	408	18.1
5301	TOKAI CARBON	Gl.&Cer.Prod	391	17.8
7974	NINTENDO	Other Prod.	11,642	17.8
5838	RAKUTEN BANK	Banks	1,119	17.2
9107	KAWASAKI KISEN	Marine Trans	2,128	16.8
2607	FUJI OIL	Foods	405	16.5
7846	PILOT	Other Prod.	236	16.2
5831	SHIZUOKA FINANCIAL GROUP	Banks	2,140	16.0
7733	OLYMPUS	Prec. Inst.	2,347	15.7
4004	RESONAC HOLDINGS	Chemicals	3,029	15.4
8308	RESONA HOLDINGS	Banks	5,837	15.4
9101	NIPPON YUSEN	Marine Trans	2,853	15.2
9503	KANSAI ELECTRIC POWER	Elec.Pwr&Gas	3,134	15.2
4203	SUMITOMO BAKELITE	Chemicals	661	15.1
4587	PEPTIDREAM	Pharm.	142	15.1
6532	BAYCURRENT	Services	1,231	14.7
7189	NISHI-NIPPON FINANCIAL HOLDING	Banks	714	14.3
8341	77 BANK	Banks	918	14.2
2181	PERSOL HOLDINGS	Services	686	14.2
7167	MEBUKI FINANCIAL GROUP	Banks	1,617	14.1
9508	KYUSHU ELECTRIC POWER	Elec.Pwr&Gas	961	13.9
4631	DIC	Chemicals	479	13.9
9432	NTT	Inf.&Com.	15,620	13.2
4307	NOMURA RESEARCH INSTITUTE	Inf.&Com.	2,969	12.9

Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

Note: based on TOPIX500, listed in descending order of share price return. This is a screen and not a recommended list either individually or as a group of stocks and options. Investors should consider the fundamentals of the companies and their own individual circumstances / objectives before making any investment decisions.

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Exhibit 6: TOPIX500: Bottom 50 stocks for returns in August

Stocks with the largest share-price decline in August

Code	Name	Sector	Market cap (bnJPY)	Return (%)
6141 DMG MORI		Machinery	470	-19.6
6361 EBARA		Machinery	2,141	-15.8
6954 FANUC		Elec. App.	5,948	-15.1
6951 JEOL		Elec. App.	365	-14.0
6728 ULVAC		Elec. App.	370	-13.3
6707 SANKEN ELECTRIC		Elec. App.	153	-12.3
9065 SANKYU		Land Trans.	441	-12.1
5105 TOYO TIRE		Rubber Prod.	581	-12.0
6841 YOKOGAWA ELECTRIC		Elec. App.	1,315	-11.6
6368 ORGANO		Machinery	602	-11.5
5334 NITERRA		Gl.&Cer.Prod	1,664	-11.3
6920 LASERTEC		Elec. App.	3,172	-11.3
7532 PAN PACIFIC INTERNATIONAL HOLD		Retail Trade	2,564	-10.6
6976 TAIYO YUDEN		Elec. App.	1,263	-10.2
4901 FUJIFILM HOLDINGS		Chemicals	4,184	-10.1
1812 KAJIMA		Construction	2,340	-10.1
7003 MITSUI E&S		Machinery	454	-9.6
6367 DAIKIN INDUSTRIES		Machinery	6,201	-9.2
5214 NIPPON ELECTRIC GLASS		Gl.&Cer.Prod	434	-8.9
6632 JVCKENWOOD		Elec. App.	167	-8.8
6479 MINEBEA MITSUMI		Elec. App.	1,444	-8.7
5332 TOTO		Gl.&Cer.Prod	1,066	-8.6
6856 HORIBA		Elec. App.	991	-8.6
6845 AZBIL		Elec. App.	828	-8.2
6544 JAPAN ELEVATOR SERVICE HOLDING		Services	279	-7.9
8830 SUMITOMO REALTY & DEVELOPMENT		Real Estate	3,113	-7.7
6370 KURITA WATER INDUSTRIES		Machinery	939	-7.5
5444 YAMATO KOGYO		Iron & Steel	775	-7.4
9983 FAST RETAILING		Retail Trade	23,055	-7.3
6113 AMADA		Machinery	821	-7.2
9302 MITSUI-SOKO HOLDINGS		Whsng&H.Tr.S	261	-7.1
4980 DEXERIALS		Chemicals	537	-7.0
4755 RAKUTEN GROUP		Services	1,693	-6.9
4751 CYBERAGENT		Services	687	-6.9
3360 SHIP HEALTHCARE HOLDINGS		Whsle Trade	225	-6.9
7012 KAWASAKI HEAVY INDUSTRIES		Trans.Equip.	2,263	-6.6
3288 OPEN HOUSE GROUP		Real Estate	928	-6.6
7649 SUGI HOLDINGS		Retail Trade	515	-6.4
8111 GOLDWIN		Text&Apparel	306	-6.2
2501 SAPPORO BREWERIES		Foods	744	-6.1
6269 MODEC		Machinery	663	-6.0
9064 YAMATO HOLDINGS		Land Trans.	703	-5.7
9735 SECOM		Services	3,029	-5.7
5201 AGC		Gl.&Cer.Prod	1,247	-5.6
9364 KAMIGUMI		Whsng&H.Tr.S	521	-5.6
6503 MITSUBISHI ELECTRIC		Elec. App.	11,802	-5.5
4704 TREND MICRO		Inf.&Com.	845	-5.4
1802 OBAYASHI		Construction	2,070	-5.4
8086 NIPRO		Prec. Inst.	264	-5.4
4182 MITSUBISHI GAS CHEMICAL		Chemicals	841	-5.4

Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

Note: based on TOPIX500, listed in ascending order of share price return. This is a screen and not a recommended list either individually or as a group of stocks and options. Investors should consider the fundamentals of the companies and their own individual circumstances / objectives before making any investment decisions.

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Exhibit 7: TOPIX500: Top 50 stocks for recurring profit revisions

Stocks with the largest upward revisions of analyst estimates in August (compared with three months earlier)

Code	Name	Sector	Market cap (bnJPY)	RP revision (%, vs. 3 month before)
2501	SAPPORO BREWERIES	Foods	744	1115.9
6707	SANKEN ELECTRIC	Elec. App.	153	256.3
5711	MITSUBISHI MATERIALS	Nonfer.Mtls	744	87.4
7267	HONDA MOTOR	Trans.Equip.	7,751	77.9
6645	OMRON	Elec. App.	1,374	65.3
5803	FUJIKURA	Nonfer.Mtls	9,771	47.0
6448	BROTHER INDUSTRIES	Elec. App.	1,229	44.5
6723	RENESAS ELECTRONICS	Elec. App.	6,345	43.9
7201	NISSAN MOTOR	Trans.Equip.	1,220	43.3
2432	DENA	Inf.&Com.	265	37.7
7272	YAMAHA MOTOR	Trans.Equip.	1,945	37.5
6857	ADVANTEST	Elec. App.	24,661	36.4
9107	KAWASAKI KISEN	Marine Trans	2,128	36.1
6141	DMG MORI	Machinery	470	35.2
6952	CASIO COMPUTER	Elec. App.	575	35.1
9104	MITSUI O.S.K. LINES	Marine Trans	2,543	33.9
3401	TEIJIN	Text&Apparel	348	30.7
9101	NIPPON YUSEN	Marine Trans	2,853	30.4
8591	ORIX	Oth.Fin.Bus.	7,064	29.1
4062	IBIDEN	Elec. App.	5,800	28.9
6134	FUJI	Machinery	698	28.9
5801	FURUKAWA ELECTRIC	Nonfer.Mtls	2,841	28.6
5714	DOWA HOLDINGS	Nonfer.Mtls	620	28.0
6481	THK	Machinery	790	26.4
5076	INFRENEER HOLDINGS	Construction	842	25.9
6302	SUMITOMO HEAVY INDUSTRIES	Machinery	708	24.1
4755	RAKUTEN GROUP	Services	1,693	23.8
9984	SOFTBANK GROUP	Inf.&Com.	29,702	23.2
6136	OSG	Machinery	357	23.2
9147	NIPPON EXPRESS HOLDINGS	Land Trans.	1,403	22.9
8282	KS HOLDINGS	Retail Trade	327	22.4
9513	ELECTRIC POWER DEVELOPMENT	Elec.Pwr&Gas	722	22.0
6098	RECRUIT HOLDINGS	Services	26,822	21.9
5838	RAKUTEN BANK	Banks	1,119	21.8
6525	KOKUSAI ELECTRIC	Elec. App.	2,087	21.7
3132	MACNICA HOLDINGS	Whsle Trade	664	21.5
4114	NIPPON SHOKUBAI	Chemicals	401	21.4
9962	MISUMI GROUP	Whsle Trade	1,073	21.4
7731	NIKON	Prec. Inst.	644	20.6
6724	SEIKO EPSON	Elec. App.	1,206	20.4
3436	SUMCO	Metal Prod.	1,191	20.3
6965	HAMAMATSU PHOTONICS	Elec. App.	757	19.9
285A	KIOXIA HOLDINGS	Elec. App.	27,417	19.2
6326	KUBOTA	Machinery	3,339	18.8
5334	NITERRA	Gl.&Cer.Prod	1,664	18.7
6976	TAIYO YUDEN	Elec. App.	1,263	17.1
9831	YAMADA HOLDINGS	Retail Trade	693	16.4
4631	DIC	Chemicals	479	16.2
8630	SOMPO HOLDINGS	Insurance	6,399	16.0
6273	SMC	Machinery	4,516	16.0

Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

Note: based on TOPIX500, listed in descending order of recurring profit revision. Estimated value is based on QUICK consensus. This is a screen and not a recommended list either individually or as a group of stocks and options. Investors should consider the fundamentals of the companies and their own individual circumstances / objectives before making any investment decisions.

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Exhibit 8: TOPIX500: Bottom 50 stocks for recurring profit revisions

Stocks with the largest downward revisions of analyst estimates in August (compared with three months earlier)

Code	Name	Sector	Market cap (bnJPY)	RP revision (% vs. 3 month before)
3994	MONEY FORWARD	Inf.&Com.	359	-35.5
4587	PEPTIDREAM	Pharm.	142	-27.0
3861	OJI HOLDINGS	Pulp&Paper	808	-26.3
7313	TS TECH	Trans.Equip.	229	-23.8
1911	SUMITOMO FORESTRY	Construction	832	-23.6
9504	CHUGOKU ELECTRIC POWER	Elec.Pwr&Gas	390	-20.6
5214	NIPPON ELECTRIC GLASS	Gl.&Cer.Prod	434	-19.0
5844	KYOTO FINANCIAL GROUP	Banks	1,503	-17.7
6472	NTN	Machinery	224	-17.6
5021	COSMO ENERGY HOLDINGS	Oil&Coal P.	706	-15.7
6417	SANKYO	Machinery	462	-14.9
9505	HOKURIKU ELECTRIC POWER	Elec.Pwr&Gas	214	-14.6
3697	SHIFT	Inf.&Com.	256	-14.3
5019	IDEMITSU KOSAN	Oil&Coal P.	1,737	-13.7
5401	NIPPON STEEL	Iron & Steel	3,599	-12.9
4202	DAICEL	Chemicals	380	-11.5
4704	TREND MICRO	Inf.&Com.	845	-11.2
2206	EZAKI GLICO	Foods	354	-10.7
9045	KEIHAN HOLDINGS	Land Trans.	342	-10.3
2593	ITO EN	Foods	356	-9.8
9501	TOKYO ELECTRIC POWER COMPANY H	Elec.Pwr&Gas	1,909	-9.7
6753	SHARP	Elec. App.	432	-9.1
5232	SUMITOMO OSAKA CEMENT	Gl.&Cer.Prod	183	-9.1
9468	KADOKAWA	Inf.&Com.	553	-9.0
4887	SAWAI GROUP HOLDINGS	Pharm.	185	-8.9
6460	SEGA SAMMY HOLDINGS	Machinery	662	-8.8
7211	mitsubishi MOTORS	Trans.Equip.	575	-8.4
9502	CHUBU ELECTRIC POWER	Elec.Pwr&Gas	2,178	-8.4
6728	ULVAC	Elec. App.	370	-8.1
3659	NEXON	Inf.&Com.	2,474	-7.6
7459	MEDIPAL HOLDINGS	Whsle Trade	625	-7.4
4118	KANEKA	Chemicals	393	-7.3
6632	JVCKENWOOD	Elec. App.	167	-7.0
5105	TOYO TIRE	Rubber Prod.	581	-6.8
9031	NISHI-NIPPON RAILROAD	Land Trans.	248	-6.8
6361	EBARA	Machinery	2,141	-6.7
6506	YASKAWA ELECTRIC	Elec. App.	1,275	-6.5
9042	HANKYU HANSHIN HOLDINGS	Land Trans.	1,182	-6.5
9404	NIPPON TELEVISION HOLDINGS	Inf.&Com.	794	-6.4
6902	DENSO	Trans.Equip.	5,633	-6.3
9503	KANSAI ELECTRIC POWER	Elec.Pwr&Gas	3,134	-6.2
4613	KANSAI PAINT	Chemicals	513	-5.8
8113	UNICHARM	Chemicals	1,857	-5.8
5233	TAIHEIYO CEMENT	Gl.&Cer.Prod	501	-5.8
9302	mitsui-SOKO HOLDINGS	Whsng&H.Tr.S	261	-5.6
7532	PAN PACIFIC INTERNATIONAL HOLD	Retail Trade	2,564	-5.6
5706	mitsui KINZOKU	Nonfer.Mtls	1,685	-5.6
7988	NIFCO	Chemicals	531	-5.6
9001	TOBU RAILWAY	Land Trans.	594	-5.3
9072	NIKKON HOLDINGS	Land Trans.	698	-5.2

Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

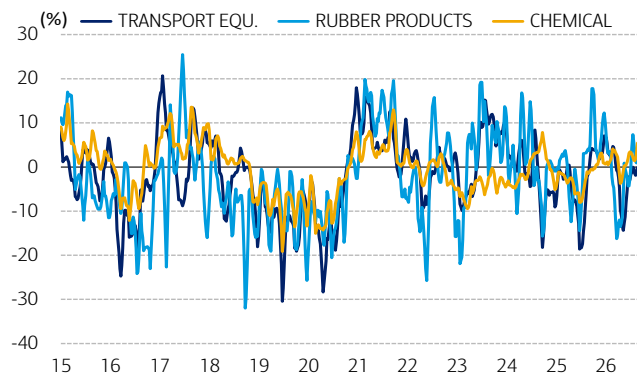
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Exhibit 9: Revision index for 33 sectors

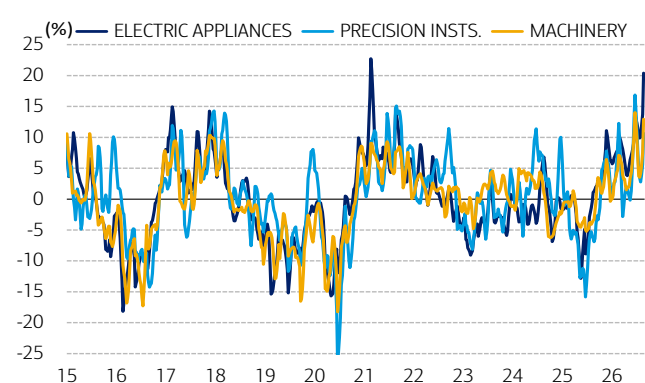
Upward/downward revisions of analyst earnings estimates



Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

Note: based on 4-week moving average of the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast EPS
BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH**Exhibit 10: Revision index for 33 sectors**

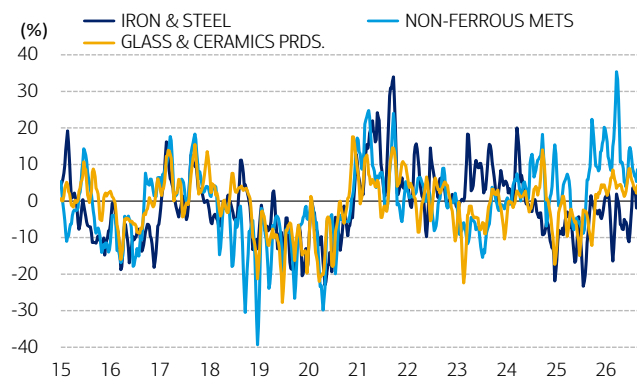
Upward/downward revisions of analyst earnings estimates



Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

Note: based on 4-week moving average of the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast EPS
BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH**Exhibit 11: Revision index for 33 sectors**

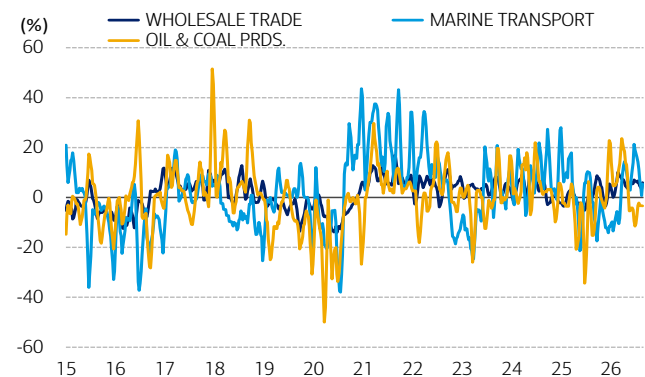
Upward/downward revisions of analyst earnings estimates



Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

Note: based on 4-week moving average of the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast EPS
BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH**Exhibit 12: Revision index for 33 sectors**

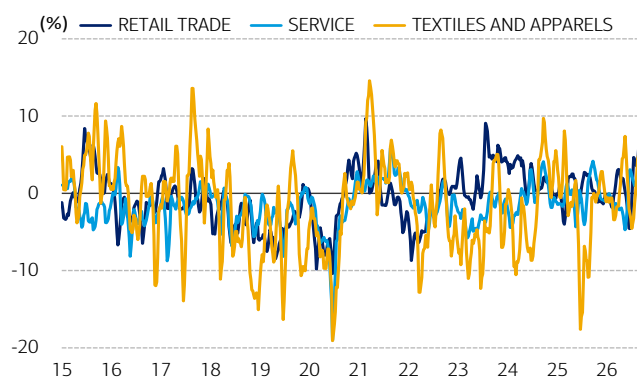
Upward/downward revisions of analyst earnings estimates



Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

Note: based on 4-week moving average of the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast EPS
BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH**Exhibit 13: Revision index for 33 sectors**

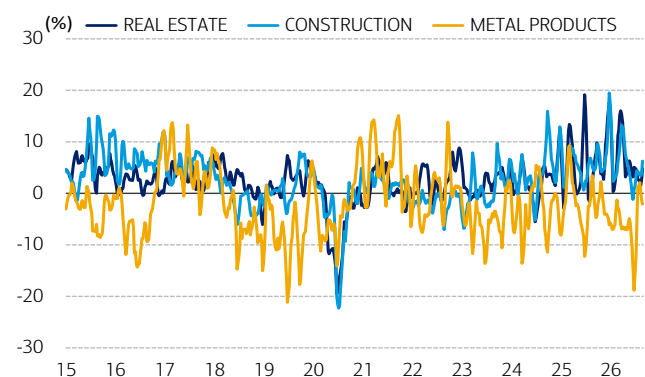
Upward/downward revisions of analyst earnings estimates



Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

Note: based on 4-week moving average of the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast EPS
BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH**Exhibit 14: Revision index for 33 sectors**

Upward/downward revisions of analyst earnings estimates

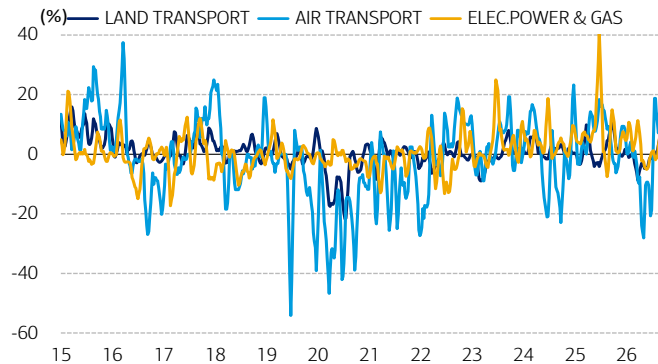


Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

Note: based on 4-week moving average of the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast EPS
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Exhibit 15: Revision index for 33 sectors

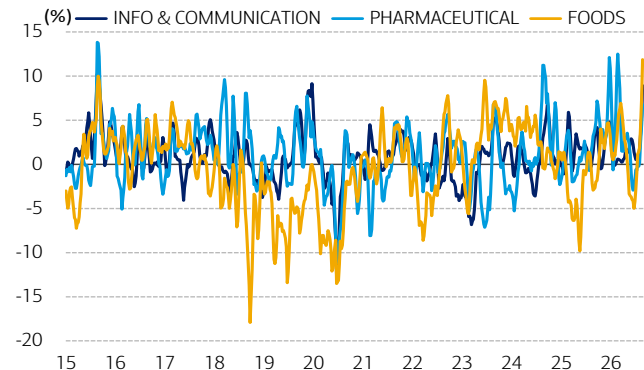
Upward/downward revisions of analyst earnings estimates



Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

Note: based on 4-week moving average of the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast EPS
BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH**Exhibit 16: Revision index for 33 sectors**

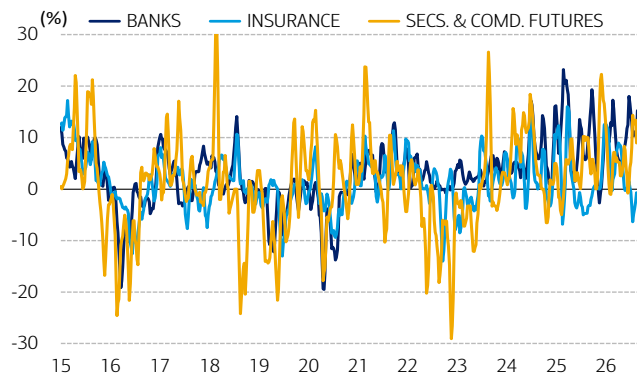
Upward/downward revisions of analyst earnings estimates



Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

Note: based on 4-week moving average of the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast EPS
BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH**Exhibit 17: Revision index for 33 sectors**

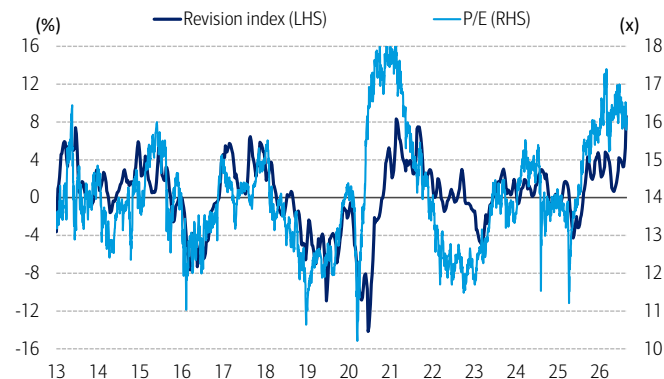
Upward/downward revisions of analyst earnings estimates



Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

Note: based on 4-week moving average of the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast EPS
BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH**Exhibit 18: TOPIX revision index and 12-month forward forecast P/E**

Revisions improve to record-high levels on current data (four-week moving average shown below)



Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

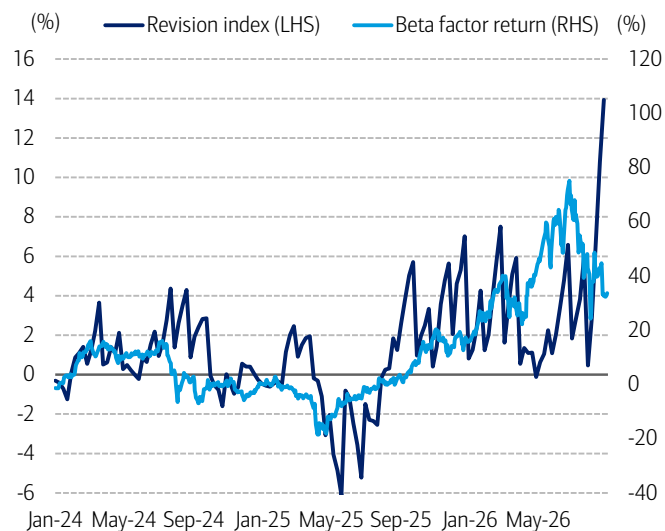
Note: Revision index is based on 4-week moving average. P/E is based on the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast EPS

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Exhibit 19: TOPIX revision index and Beta factor return

Beta factor and earnings estimate revisions show a positive correlation



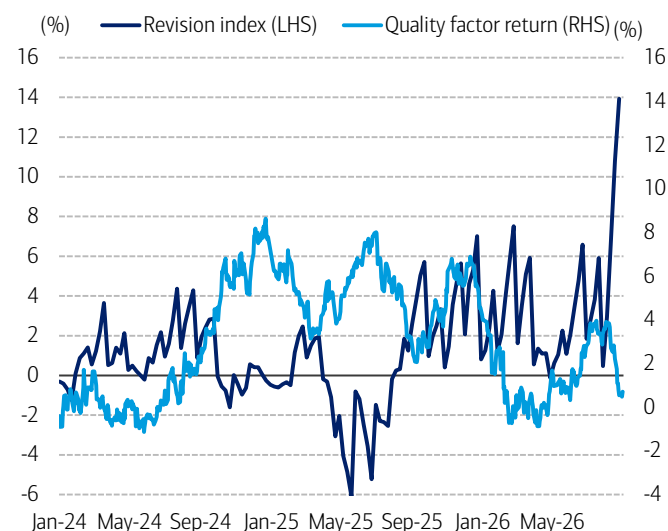
Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG, QUICK

Note: Revision index is based on the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast

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Exhibit 20: TOPIX revision index and Quality factor return

Quality factor and earnings estimate revision index are negatively correlate



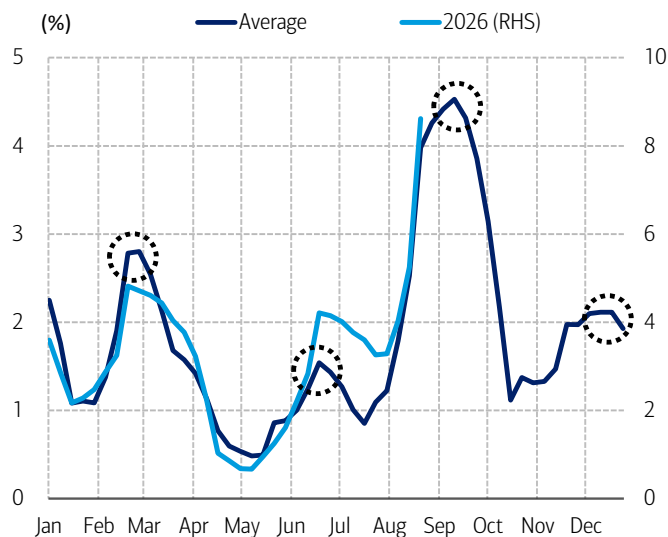
Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG, QUICK

Note: Revision index is based on the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast

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Exhibit 21: Earnings recovery phase and revision index (TOPIX) in 2026

Revisions improved most into September



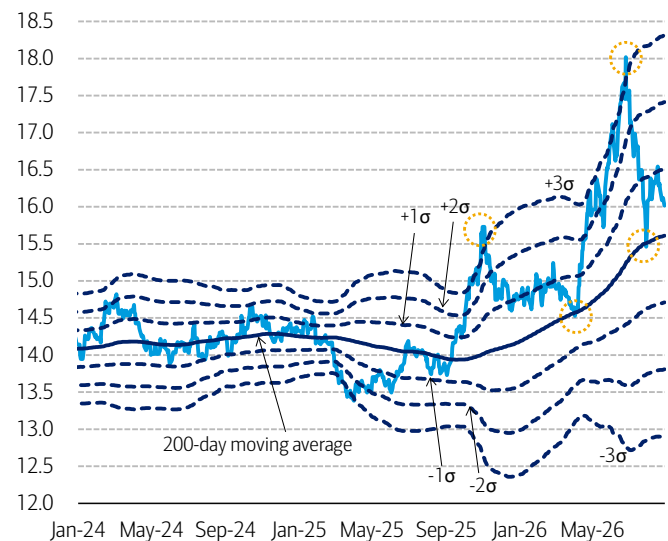
Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG, QUICK

Note: The average revision is calculated since 2017, excluding 2018 and 2019 which revisions were negative and the pandemic year 2020, and comparing it with those for 2026.

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Exhibit 22: N/T ratio

N/T ratio bottoms out, but upward momentum weak

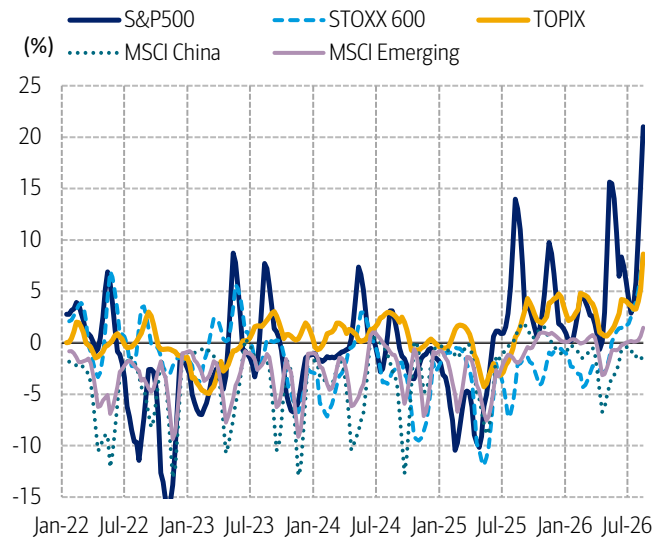


Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg

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Exhibit 23: Revision index for main global indices

Revisions sharply improving around the world



Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

Note: based on 4-week moving average of the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast EPS
BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH**Exhibit 24: Relative revision index and share prices for cyclicals and defensives sectors**

Relative revisions for cyclical sectors had peaked out in positive territory



Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

Note: based on 4-week moving average of the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast EPS
BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH**Exhibit 25: 12-month forward P/E for major markets**

P/E expansion slowing globally



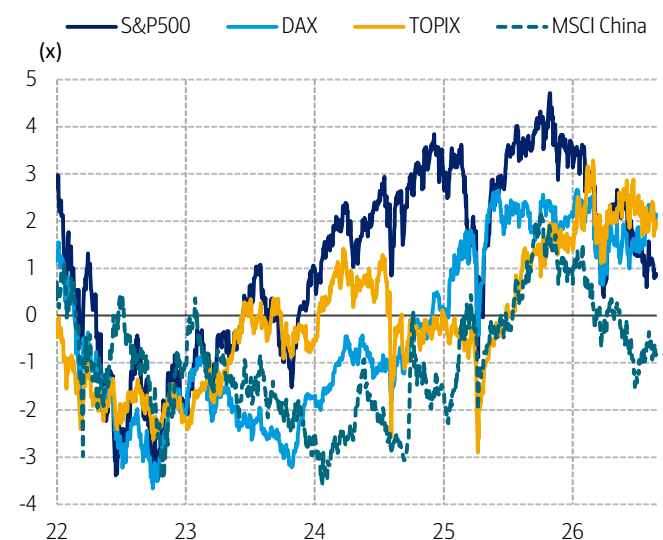
Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

Note: P/E is based on the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast

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Exhibit 26: Deviation of 12-month forward P/E from the average since 2015 for major markets

Excluding China, P/E multiples across countries remain above average



Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG

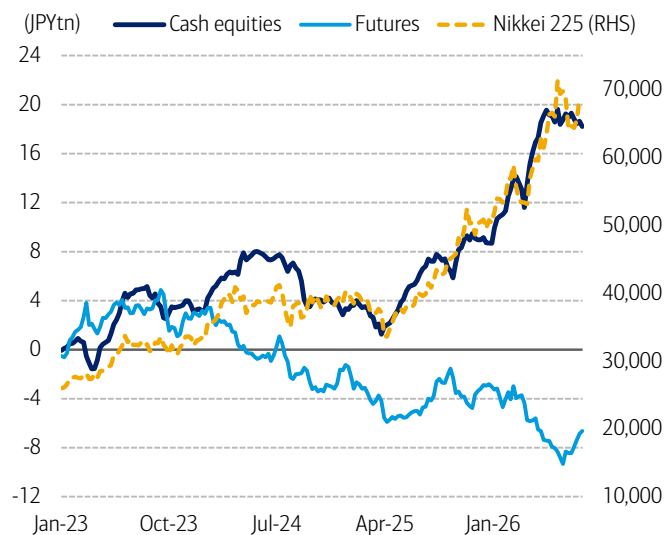
Note: P/E is based on the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast

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Exhibit 27: TOPIX Overseas investors cumulative net purchases (cash, futures) and TOPIX

Rapid buying on cash market by foreign investors eases



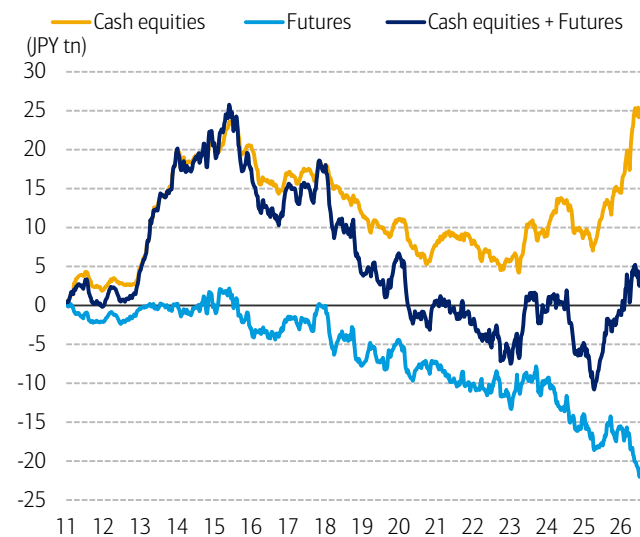
Source: BofA Global Research, LSEG, QUICK

Note: ROE is based on the I/B/E/S consensus 12-month forward forecast

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Exhibit 28: Overseas investors cumulative net purchases (cash, futures)

Overseas investors have bought back all the cash equities they sold since 2015

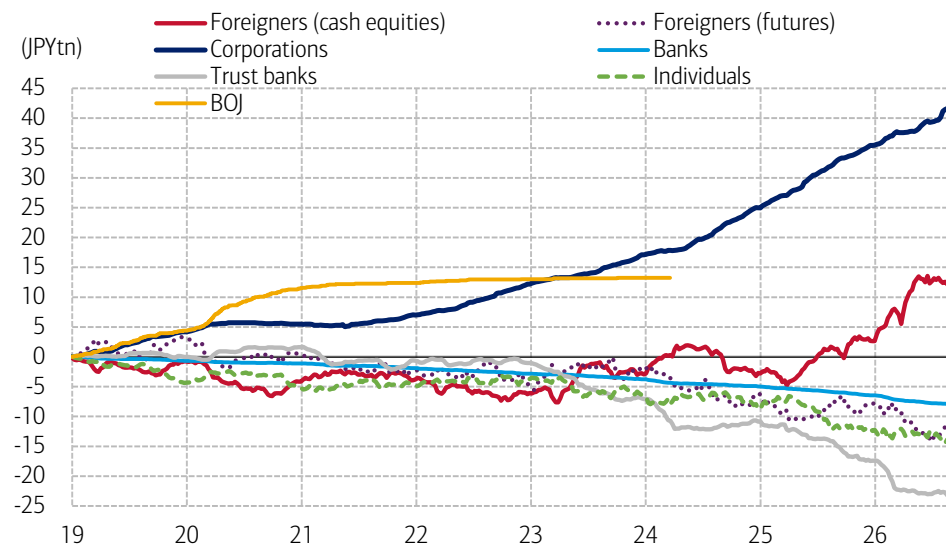


Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

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Exhibit 29: Cumulative net buying/selling by investor category

Share buybacks are a stable buyer of Japanese equities; Net buying accelerated after 1Q results

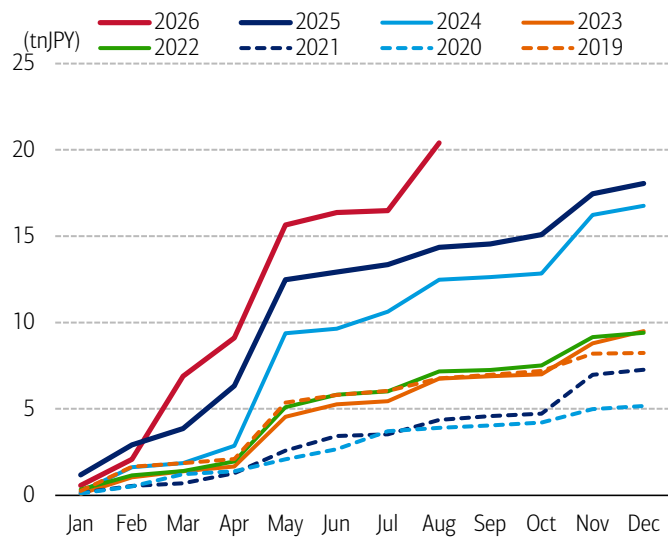


Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

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Exhibit 30: Annual share buyback budgets

Share buybacks increasing at a pace exceeding last year's record level



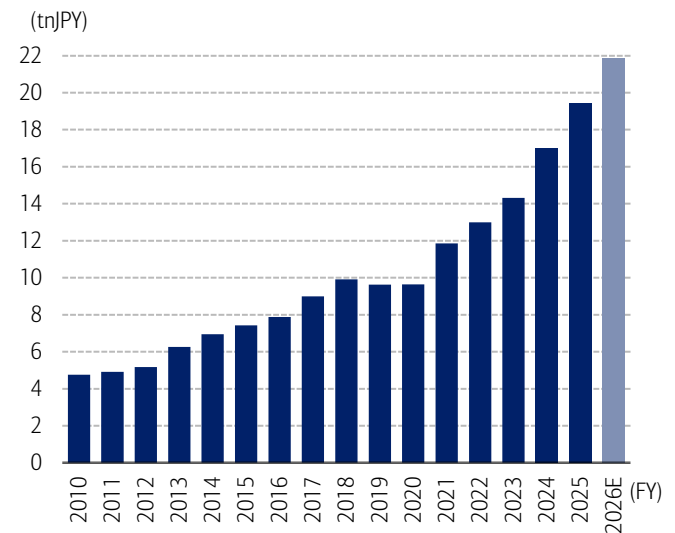
Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

Note: based on TOPIX constituents

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Exhibit 31: Total dividends

Dividends look likely to increase significantly in FY2026



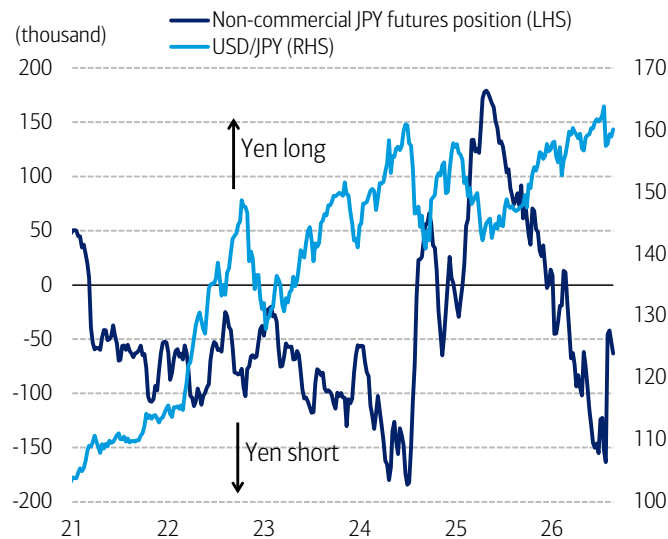
Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

Note: based on TOPIX constituents with fiscal year ending in Feb-Mar, their dividend data available since end-2009. QUICK forecast consensus data (or forecast data by TOYO KEIZAI Inc. if QUICK is not available) is used for FY26.

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Exhibit 32: CFTC Non-commercial JPY futures position and USD/JPY (since 2000)

Following forex market intervention, non-commercial short yen positions were rapidly unwound

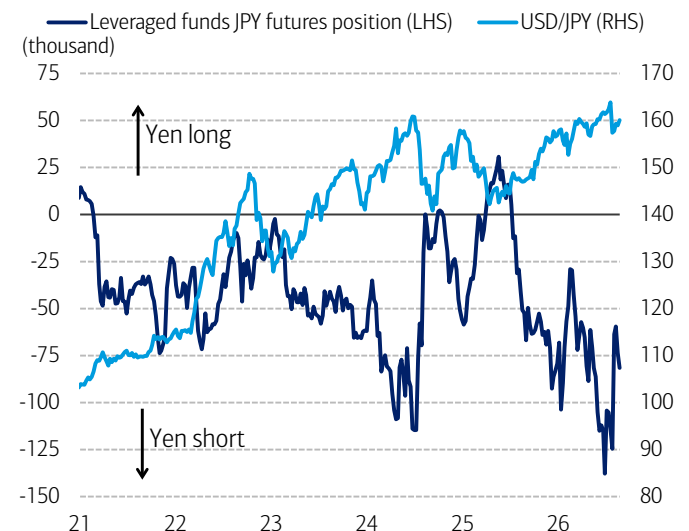


Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg

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Exhibit 33: CFTC leveraged funds JPY futures position and USD/JPY

Same was true for leveraged funds



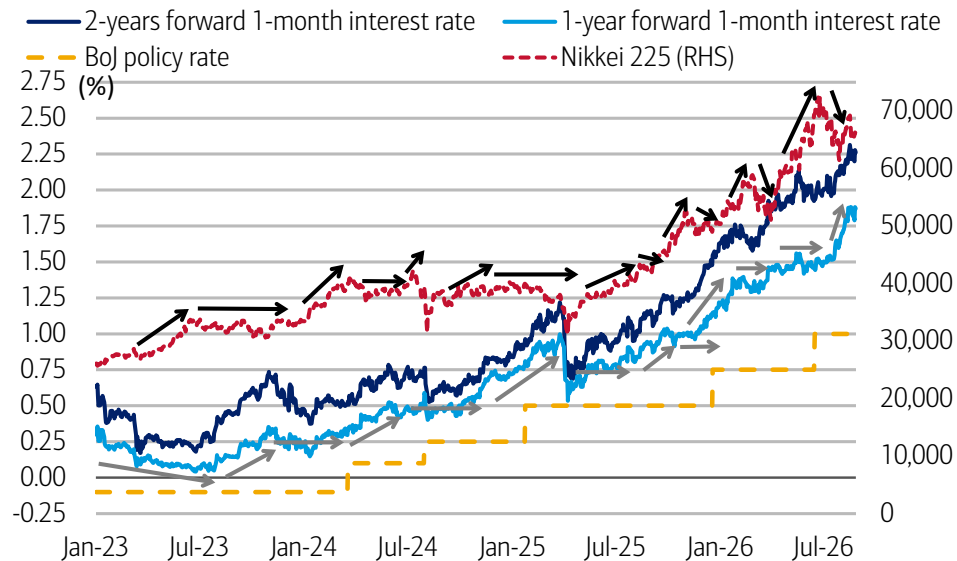
Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg

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Exhibit 34: 1y forward/2y forward 1-month interest rates, BoJ policy rate and Nikkei 225

1y and 2y forward rates began to stabilize after rising sharply

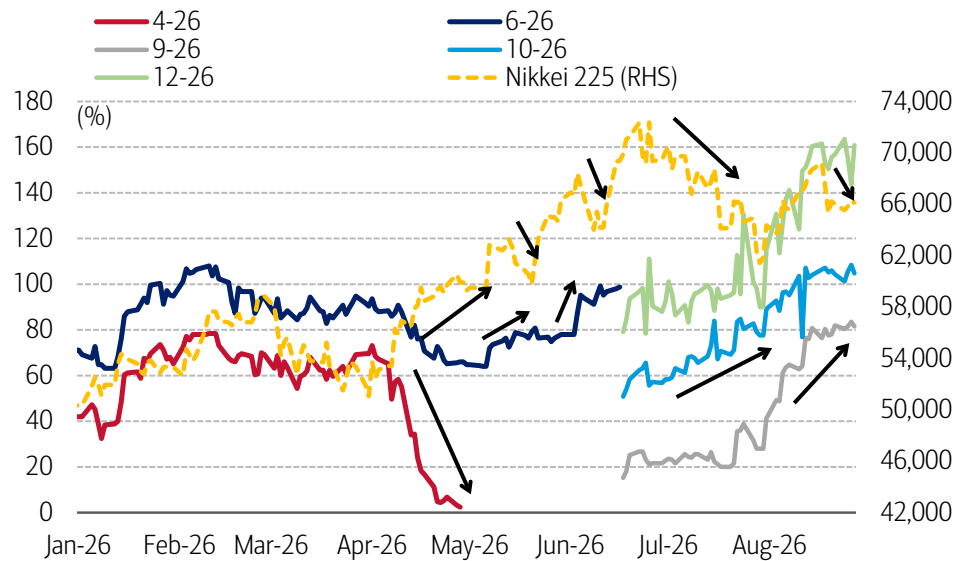


Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg

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Exhibit 35: BoJ rate hike expectations at each policy meeting implied by the OIS market, Nikkei

Probability of a September rate hike is 84%; October is 100%

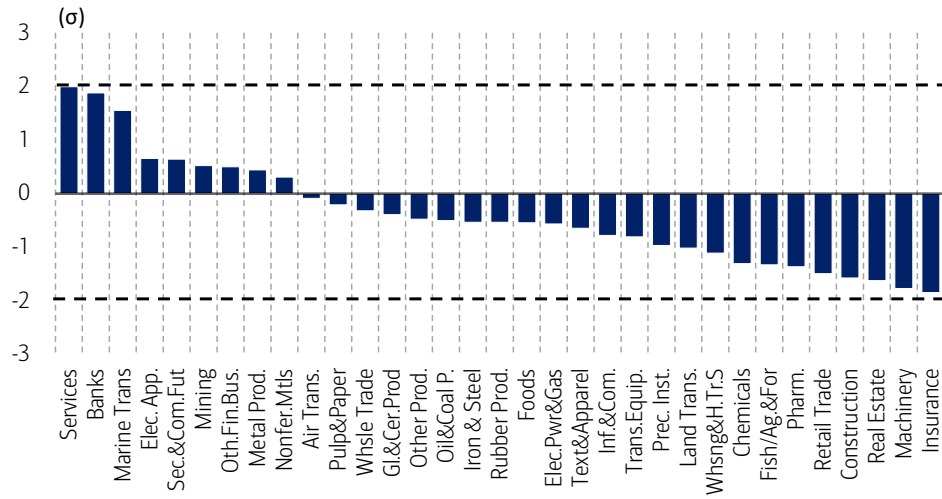


Source: BofA Global Research, Bloomberg

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Exhibit 36: Z-scores of sector-relative P/B (vs TOPIX)

P/B rose for services and bank, declined for insurance and machinery



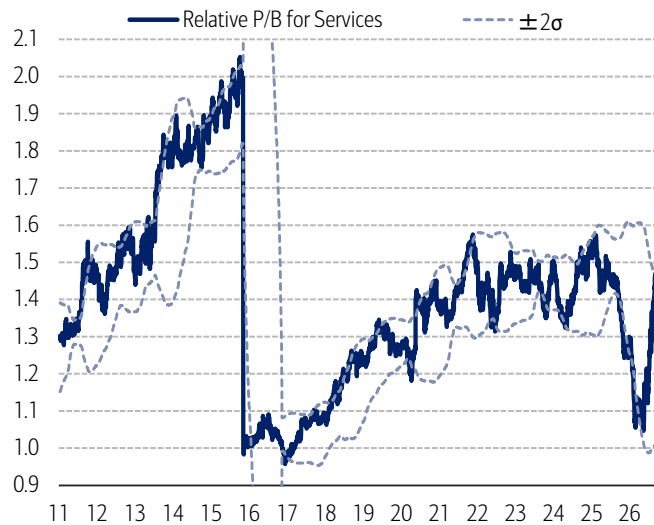
Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

Note: Measures deviation of current P/B multiples from 250-day average for each sector relative to TOPIX

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Exhibit 37: Top 3 sectors by Z-score

Trend in sector P/B (relative to market)

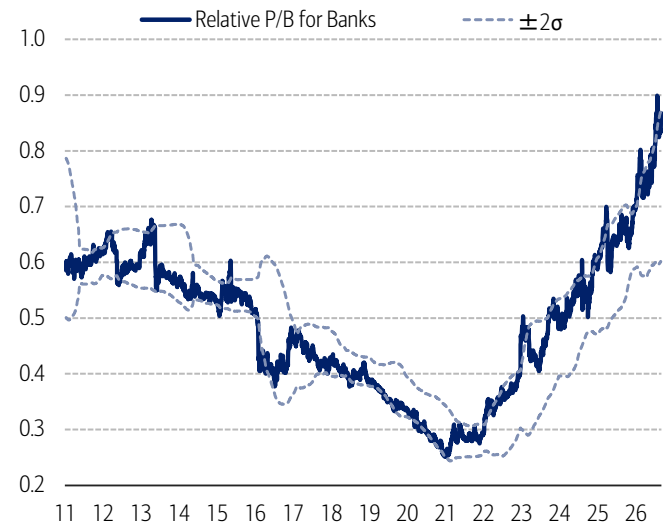


Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

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Exhibit 38: Top 3 sectors by Z-score

Trend in sector P/B (relative to market)



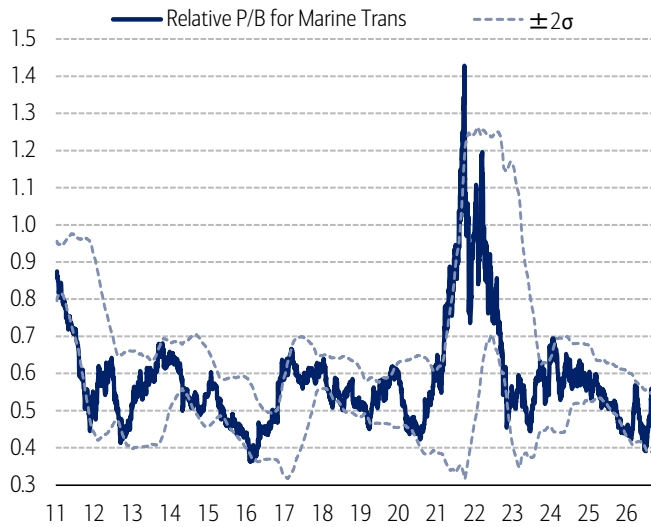
Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

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Exhibit 39: Top 3 sectors by Z-score

Trend in sector P/B (relative to market)

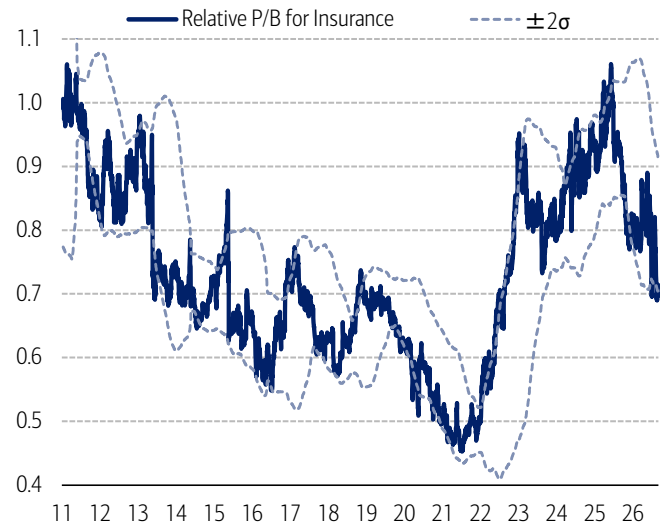


Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

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Exhibit 40: Bottom 3 sectors by Z-score

Trend in sector P/B (relative to market)

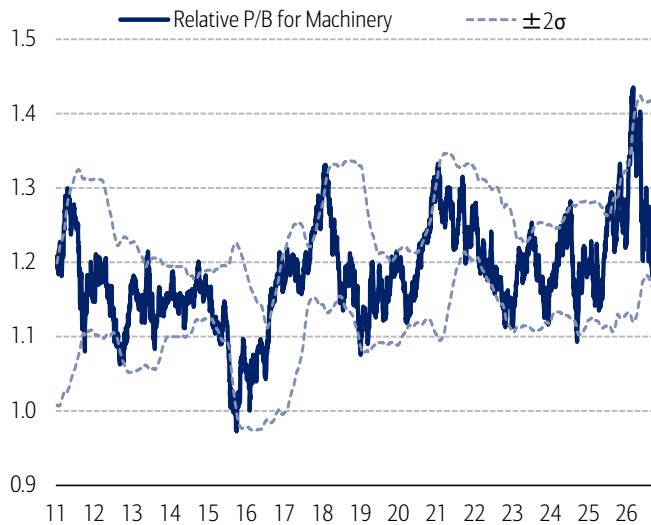


Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

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Exhibit 41: Bottom 3 sectors by Z-score

Trend in sector P/B (relative to market)

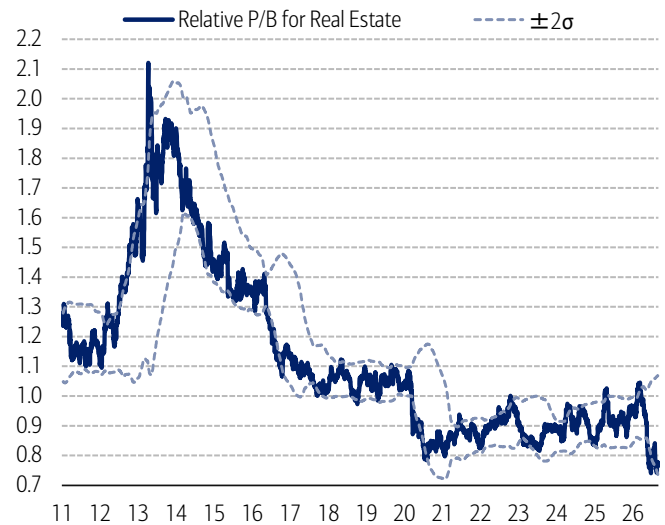


Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

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Exhibit 42: Bottom 3 sectors by Z-score

Trend in sector P/B (relative to market)



Source: BofA Global Research, QUICK

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Neutral	≥ 0%	≤ 30%
Underperform	N/A	≥ 20%

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